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Historical Linguistics: An Introduction. **By Lyle Campbell. Cambridge, MA: MIT Press, 1999.**

Why a new textbook of historical linguistics? With a number of serviceable texts still in print (e.g., Arlotto 1972, Bynon 1977), newly revised (e.g., Crowley 1997), or recently published (e.g., Hock and Joseph 1996), it would seem difficult to justify another entry into the field. But Campbell's book (originally published in 1998 by the Edinburgh University Press, which presumably accounts for the pervasive British orthography, an odd feature for an MIT Press volume) is welcome indeed: this is historical linguistics with a difference, namely a practical emphasis (as Campbell writes in the preface) on the "hands-on" procedures of actually *doing* historical linguistics—learning how to apply techniques to data—rather than just talking about it. It is too soon to pass judgment on the book's performance as a course text (I have not yet had an opportunity to evaluate it in this context), but considered on its own terms this is likely to be a valuable addition to the available textbook options for introductory courses on historical linguistics.

The book is pitched slightly higher than Arlotto 1972 (Campbell assumes that users will have taken an introductory course in linguistics) and is considerably more compendious; but the theoretical discussions are not as technical as in higher-level texts like Anttila 1989 or Hock 1991. One of the hallmarks of this book, in fact, is Campbell's appealingly direct and simple prose style, which tends to the colloquial (the reader is often addressed in the second person). While Campbell does not shy away from technical notations and terminology (there is a helpful introductory section on "Phonetic Symbols and Conventions" and an IPA-based "Phonetic Symbols Chart," as well as a full bibliography, and thorough indexes of languages, names, and subjects), jargon for jargon's sake is eschewed, and most of the theoretical discussions should be highly accessible to students with relatively little linguistic background.

The coverage of the book is itself somewhat unusual. In addition to chapters on standard topic areas like "Sound Change," "Borrowing," "Analogical Change," "The Comparative Method and Linguistic Reconstruction," there are chapters on subjects less commonly treated in any depth in such texts, such as "Syntactic Change," "Areal Linguistics," "Distant Genetic Relationship" (a particularly rich and worthwhile treatment), "Philology: The role of written records," and "Linguistic Prehistory." The coverage is thus both relatively deep and extremely broad, a feature that is distinctly enhanced by Campbell's effective use of linguistic data. Campbell's discussions provide a wealth of carefully selected examples (nine of the fifteen chapters offer exercises based on real-language data), intentionally chosen both from familiar European languages (mainly English and other Germanic languages, Latin and the Romance languages) and from non-Indo-European languages (mainly, but far from exclusively, Amerindian and Uralic languages, based on Campbell's own work).

It may be helpful to profile a typical chapter in detail. Chapter 8, "Internal Reconstruction," begins with a one-paragraph "Introduction" that character-

izes the subject and concludes with the promise that "[i]n this chapter, we will learn how to apply internal reconstruction, and we will take its uses and limitations into account." This is followed by a section called "Internal Reconstruction Illustrated," which begins with an annotated checklist of four major steps to be applied in typical procedures involving internal reconstruction; Campbell then takes the reader on a step-by-step guided tour, as it were, of three actual examples (Tojolabal, Nahuatl, English) that illustrate the basic concepts involved. Then comes a section on "Relative Chronology," itself exemplified by detailed discussions of three additional data sets (one from Spanish and two from Classical Greek). The expository part of the chapter concludes with discussions of "The Limitations of Internal Reconstruction" (with data adduced from Sanskrit and from the history of English) and "Internal Reconstruction and the Comparative Method" (with data from Balto-Finnic languages). The chapter itself concludes with a series of seven exercises, with data sets (some quite extensive) drawn from Tz'utujil (Mayan), Poqomchi' (Mayan), Kaqchikel (Mayan), American Spanish, Finnish, Nahuatl, and Jicaque.

Potential Indo-Europeanist users may wish to know that despite the impression conveyed by the preceding list, a fair amount of traditional Indo-European material receives prominent coverage, including Grimm's, Verner's and Grassmann's Laws, rhotacism in Latin and Germanic, Germanic umlaut, merger of PIE vowels in Indic, and the "ruki" rule, among many other individual processes cited for various ancient IE languages (and a number of modern ones). The chapter on "Linguistic Prehistory," moreover, devotes a lengthy sub-section to "Indo-European Linguistic Prehistory" (with four pages of reconstructed etyma distributed among categories like "social structure and people," "economy," "agriculture," etc.), and considers, in another sub-section, the "Proto-Indo-European homeland."

The Indo-European material itself is largely correct, but far from error-free, including incorrect notations of some consequence like OLat. nom. sg. *honos* [*sic*] vs. Class. *honor* and dat. *honōrī* (36, 96), or Gk. *poiésō* [*sic*] beside correct *lū́sō* (288), not to mention cases where vowel length and other problems are less germane to Campbell's point (e.g., Gk. *thū́r-a* 'door' [*ū sic*] and, still worse, aor. *é-phu* 'I brought forth' [*sic*; vowel length, ending, and gloss all wrong] both on p. 140, but the point here is Gk. *th-* and *ph-* vs. Skt. *d(h)-* and *bh-*); wrong forms and reconstructions, e.g., Gk. *eimés* [*sic*] labeled as 1 sg. of 'to be' (318) or **k^{w}on-* [*sic*] as the IE etymon for 'dog' (343); mistaken or highly questionable claims, e.g., that PIE **b^{h}erg^{h}-* [*sic*; Campbell does not distinguish PIE velars and palatals] 'high, hill, hill-fort' is "perhaps not Indo-European in origin" (341; a confusion perhaps arising somehow from Gk. πύργος? for the IE etymon see most recently Puhvel 1999:73), or the "often-cited example" (37) of Lat. *nūtrix* [*sic*, i.e., *nūtrīx*] as haplologized from *nūtri-trix* [*sic*, i.e., *nūtrī-trīx*] (an old idea explicitly rejected, for example, by Ernout-Meillet s.v. and no longer taken seriously); and miscellaneous glitches, e.g., mixed-up 2 sg. and 3 sg. forms of Gk. *hépomai* (93, *hépetai* 'you follow' [*sic*], *hépēi* 'he/she/it follows' [*sic*]). Most disappointing of all, to my mind, is the quaint Pokornian notation (**nāu-* 'boat', **arg-* 'shine', **melə-* 'grind' and the like; Campbell notes [xvi] that he has relied on Watkins 1985 for the form of IE roots). Oddly, in the chapter on the comparative method, Campbell makes a point of noting (132) that "[w]ith the discovery and decipherment of Hittite ..., the whole picture of Proto-Indo-European phonology changed; this included clearer evidence of several new proto-sounds (the laryngeals)"; it is a pity that this observation is never followed up by consideration of laryngeal theory, which would have been immensely instructive for many of the issues covered, and which would then have afforded the author an easy opportunity of updating these antiquated and by now highly misleading notations.

But these criticisms do little to detract from the essential freshness of Campbell's conception and the generally distinguished manner in which he has carried out the task. Students with some background in linguistics (and their instructors) will find this a highly congenial source of guidance for the theory, and especially the methodology, of historical linguistics.

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An Introduction to the Languages of the World. By Anatole V. Lyovin. New York and Oxford: Oxford University Press, 1997.

This volume provides a compendious survey of the languages of the world. A brief preface by the author (pp. vii–ix) is followed by a perfunctory table of contents (xi–xv) and a list of abbreviations (xvi–xviii). Chapter 1 (1–28) offers a pedagogical excursus on the methodology of genetic language classification, while chapter 2 (29–44) details the classification of known writing systems. Chapters 3 through 7 cover the various languages of the world on a continent by continent basis, treating the Americas as a unity (3. Europe, 45–108; 4. Asia, 109–184; 5. Africa, 185–244; 6. Oceania, 245–308; 7. The Americas, 309–400). An exegesis of pidgins and creoles rounds out the eighth and final chapter (401–438). The volume concludes with an appendix of maps (439–456), bibliography (457–472), a language index (473–483), and a subject index (484–491).

Lyovin states clearly in the book's preface (vii) that his work is intended for undergraduates who have mastered the basic principles of linguistics or graduate students who have had a basic introduction to some branches of the discipline, but have little background in the field as a whole. The book is not intended to be used as an introductory level textbook, nor a more advanced reference tool (cf. Comrie 1987, for example). Nevertheless, as Lyovin points out (vii–viii), the text not only reviews a number of basic linguistic concepts, but also strives to explain and define core terminology which may confuse some students. At the same time, the work aims to enable its readers to explore, at various levels, structurally diverse languages and to serve as an introduction to linguistic typology in general.

In many ways, Lyovin's preface sells his work short. The utility of this work certainly goes beyond the scope of its aims. On the one hand, the general store of information one might expect to find in a book of this sort, namely genealogical classification schemata, distributional statistics, typological observations, as well as brief phonological and morphological sketches of languages which illustrate and illuminate key pedagogical concerns, is laid out in a relatively simple and accessible format. In addition, each chapter closes with choice notes of a more advanced nature and bibliographical references to genealogical and typological topics on the one hand and language specific matters on the other.

However, what makes this book special are the pedagogical aids which supplement the aforementioned features. Specifically, I refer to the sample texts chosen by Lyovin to introduce readers to languages with extremely diverse morphosyntactic and morphophonemic structures and features. Each sample text, usually a half-page to a page in length, is followed by a complete morphemic breakdown of each word in the selection, as well as a translation and extensive grammatical notes. Such detailed sketches are included for Russian, Finnish, Mandarin Chinese, Tibetan, Modern Literary Arabic, Swahili, Hawaiian, Dyirbal, Yup'ik Eskimo, Ayacucho Quechua, and Tok Pisin. It is here, in particular, that the book's utility extends far beyond the author's intended scope and audience. These sketches enable both student and scholar alike, yet each to their own degree of acumen and interest, to work in close detail with a great variety of languages and language types. In the current state of general linguistic inquiry, where the overwhelming breadth and variety of information that the world's languages provide is often ignored in favor of theoretical concerns, such